

Jack-of-all

A jack of all trades may not know how to fly,
nor how to build 50 stories of a building quite right,
but they know how to guess, how to try, how to fail.
Sometimes breadth is needed more than detail.

You may play far better the bass or the flute.
You may build rockets, sew suit pockets, or shoot.
But if one's all that you know, you may soon need a hand,
never fear, we jack-of-alls can be one person bands.

For jack-of-alls know when there's doing to do,
many fields can combine, can work in cahoots.
An electrician invented balloons, don't you know?
And a pilot made it possible to keep organs alive ex vivo.

So remember the line that they love to misquote,
for a "master of none" keeps the whole ship afloat.
When the future is strange and the answers are new,
a jack of all trades is the master of *do*.

— Kimberly Williams, July 7th, 2026